PRODUCT DESIGN CASE STUDY / 2026

BHE CRM

From Enquiry to Enrolment

UI/UX product case study

Prepared: 28 October 2026 **Domain:** Education consultancy, student recruitment, and admissions **Project:** BHE CRM; application metadata currently uses “L2E CRM” **Current stage:** Interactive prototype with selected server integrations

This case study documents the CRM represented by the current repository. It distinguishes observable implementation from proposed improvements. It does not claim user interviews, production adoption, conversion gains, or commercial outcomes that have not been measured. Project authorship, team size, delivery timeline, and individual responsibilities have not been established.

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2. Overview

BHE CRM brings student recruitment, admissions, partner management, and commission tracking into one administrative workspace. Its central product idea is continuity: staff should be able to follow a student from first enquiry through counselling and university applications to enrolment and the associated financial activities.

The prototype expresses this through lead queues, application records, course and institution directories, communications, performance reporting, and finance screens. Shared navigation and interface components help these areas feel like parts of one product.

The implementation demonstrates substantial interface coverage. The next development challenge is to connect that coverage to durable records, real identities, enforceable permissions, and dependable business transactions.

Project detail	Case study context
Product	CRM for education consultancy teams
Design focus	Recruitment, admissions, and operational coordination
Your role	[Add your title, responsibilities, and collaborators]
Timeline	[Add actual project dates and duration]
Constraints	Multiple user roles, dense records, complex handoffs, prototype storage and integration boundaries
Deliverable demonstrated	Interactive interface spanning the student recruitment lifecycle
Impact	Production outcomes have not been measured; proposed measures appear below

4. Problem & Solution

Core problem hypothesis: Staff coordinating student recruitment need a clear view of ownership, progress, and the next action across enquiries, applications, and commissions. Fragmented handoffs can make that work difficult to prioritize.

Product solution: Bring operational records into a shared CRM, with actionable queues, staged applications, contextual communication, and financial dependencies.

Friction hypothesis	Design response	Intended benefit to validate
Enquiries have no clear owner	Assignment controls and unassigned queues	Faster routing to a responsible counsellor
Long applications are difficult to complete	Guided steps and progress feedback	Clearer requirements and fewer abandoned tasks
Teams lose track of pending work	Follow-ups, deadlines, and blocker categories	Easier identification of the next action
Records require frequent context switching	Detail drawers and contextual actions	Easier review while preserving list context
Enrolment and commissions become disconnected	Linked claim eligibility and payout states	Clearer financial follow-through

5. Researching User To Validate Design Choices

Design hypothesis	Proposed task	Evidence to collect	Decision if the hypothesis fails
Action queues help staff prioritize	Find the oldest unassigned enquiry and assign it	Completion, first-click choice, missed records	Rework queue labels and default ordering
A stepper clarifies application preparation	Complete a new application and recover from an omission	Errors, backtracking, understanding of progress	Adjust grouping, required fields, and error feedback
Drawers preserve useful context	Inspect a record and return to the filtered list	Context loss, accidental navigation, repeated searches	Change drawer depth or use a dedicated details page
Blockers make next actions clearer	Find why an application has stalled	Correct diagnosis, time, confidence	Rewrite categories and expose owner and next action
Navigation matches staff expectations	Locate document requests and commission receipts	Path taken, misclassification, task completion	Regroup modules and remove duplicate destinations

Feedback and pivots: [Add observed finding → design change → retest result once actual sessions have occurred.] The case study currently supports design rationale, not claims of validated user preference.

8. Research Process

Work completed for this documentation: repository inspection, navigation and workflow review, data-model inspection, and an implementation gap analysis. These methods establish what the prototype does; they do not establish what users need or prove usability.

No interviews, surveys, competitive study, participant counts, usability sessions, or research-led pivots have been documented in the material reviewed.

Recommended research sequence:

1. Observe front-office, counselling, admissions, management, and finance work to document tools, handoffs, and exceptions.

2. Interview representatives from those roles using recent real tasks rather than hypothetical preferences.

3. Map the current journey, separating observed problems from assumptions.

4. Review comparable CRM workflows against specific tasks, recording tradeoffs rather than copying screens.

5. Test low-fidelity navigation and core flows before evaluating visual polish.

6. Test the interactive prototype with realistic, synthetic records; record completion, errors, hesitation, and recovery.

Expected research deliverables: interview guide, anonymized observations, evidence-backed personas, current-state journey, prioritized problem statements, usability findings, and a decision log. These are proposed deliverables, not completed activities.

User Flow

Actor: Counsellor. **Entry:** Leads list. **Intended success:** a saved application linked to the original lead and visible to authorized staff.

```
Open Leads → Find enquiry → Is an owner assigned?
                              ├─ No → Assign branch and counsellor ─┐
                              └─ Yes ──────────────────────────────┤
                                                                   ↓
                          Review details → Contact student → Qualified?
                               ├─ No, more information → Schedule follow-up → Review again
                               ├─ No, unsuitable → Record lost reason → End
                               └─ Yes → Start linked application
                                        ↓
                          Personal details → Course choices → Academic history
                                        ↓
                          Work history → Documents → Language → Declaration
                                        ↓
                          Review → Required information valid?
                               ├─ No → Explain issue → Correct relevant step → Review
                               └─ Yes → Save application and link lead → Confirmation
```

This is a **proposed connected flow**. Qualification and form interfaces exist, but lead conversion is not connected to application creation, and the wizard currently displays success without saving a new application. The flow therefore specifies the intended completion behavior rather than claiming it is implemented.

User Persona

The following are **provisional personas inferred from system responsibilities**. They are hypotheses for research, not validated profiles. Demographics and invented quotations have been omitted because task context is more useful here and no participant evidence was supplied.

Persona	Goals	Assumed frustrations to validate	Expected behavior to observe
Counsellor — primary	Prioritize enquiries and move suitable students toward applications	Unclear ownership, scattered context, forgotten callbacks	Repeatedly checks assigned leads, compares courses, records follow-ups
Admissions officer — primary	Submit complete applications and resolve blockers on time	Missing documents, unclear status, repeated requests	Reviews requirements, follows deadlines, records university responses
Branch manager — secondary	Balance workload and improve branch delivery	Hidden unassigned work and inconsistent reporting	Reviews queues, assigns owners, checks pipeline and targets
Finance officer — secondary	Collect eligible commissions and release correct payouts	Unclear eligibility and disconnected payment records	Checks enrolments, prepares claims, records receipts, reviews balances

Research questions: Which tasks recur most often? Where do handoffs fail? Which information must be visible without opening a record? How do responsibilities differ by branch?

Information Architecture

The sidebar groups the product into four areas:

Area	Modules	Purpose
Main	Dashboard, Leads, Applications, Communications	Daily recruitment and admissions activity
Directory	Countries, Institutions, Courses, Office, People, Agent Management	Reference information and operational resources
Insights	Target Setup, Finance, BHE Training	Performance, revenue activity, staff development
System	Archived, Settings	Recovery and configuration

The structure gives broad administrative coverage. Some labels overlap across sections, including announcements and news feeds. A future navigation review should establish one clear home for each activity and tailor starting views to staff responsibilities.

```
BHE CRM
├── Main: Dashboard · Leads · Applications · Communications
├── Directory: Countries · Institutions · Courses · Office · People · Agents
├── Insights: Targets · Finance · Training
└── System: Archives · Settings
```

UX strategy: keep primary work visible, provide context alongside actions, break complex input into manageable steps, and use a consistent vocabulary for status and ownership. Role-specific starting views are a proposed refinement, not a validated outcome.

Scope of Work

The repository demonstrates the following deliverables. Confirm which you personally owned before publishing this as your portfolio case study.

Deliverable	Available evidence	Ownership or process evidence needed
Information architecture	Grouped sidebar and module navigation	Your role in defining and testing the hierarchy
Workflow design	Lead management, application wizard, admissions actions, finance states	Original flows and rationale for iterations
UI design	Dashboards, tables, forms, drawers, responsive layouts	Your contribution and design source files
Design system components	Shared controls, semantic colors, typography, light and dark themes	Foundation decisions and component documentation
Interactive prototyping	Working frontend with simulated operational records	Prototype versions and testing context
UX research	No primary research evidence supplied	Interview notes, surveys, observations, or competitive analysis
Wireframing	No wireframe artifacts established in this review	Early explorations and selected direction
Developer handoff	Typed components and implementation structure exist	Actual specifications, annotations, and handoff responsibility

Visual Guidelines / Color

A restrained blue identity anchors a dense operational workspace. Neutral surfaces separate content; semantic colors identify status and action.

Primary
#4D76BB
Actions, selection, data series

Accent / warning
#F59E0B
Attention and pending states

Success
#45C348
Positive status

Danger
#E53E2B
Errors and destructive actions

Background
#F8FAFC
Workspace canvas

Surface
#FFFFFF
Cards and dialogs

Foreground
#0F172A
Primary text

Muted text
#64748B
Secondary information

Border
#E2E8F0
Separation and field edges

Dark theme

Layer surfaces, preserve meaning.

Canvas #090A10 · Surface #11121C · Primary #6D93D0
Text #F1F3F9 · Border #1F2133

Tokens are taken from src/app/globals.css. Status must also use text or icons. These swatches do not imply that every foreground/background pairing passes contrast checks.

Style Guide / Type & Layout

Product typeface: Plus Jakarta Sans. The application configures weights 300–800, with system sans-serif fallbacks. This PDF uses Arial for portable rendering; the CRM screenshots show the product typography.

Your next action, clearly visible.

Page headings: examples at 24–30px, bold.

Applications needing attention

Section headings: examples at 18px, semibold or bold.

Review student details, missing documents, and upcoming deadlines.

Body and fields: examples at 14px. Supporting labels: 12px.

Spacing and layout

Pattern	Observed implementation
Spacing rhythm	Common gaps and padding use 4, 8, 12, 16, and 24px steps; specialized values also occur.
Fields	12px corner radius; 14px horizontal and 10px vertical padding.
Primary actions	Pill shape, minimum 40px height; 16px horizontal padding.
Workspace	Flexible sidebar and content; main content capped at 1600px, with 16–24px outer padding.
Containers	Rounded surfaces, thin borders, restrained shadows; radius varies by component.

Visual hierarchy

Use a clear page title, one prominent task action, supporting filters, and the main work area. Emphasize urgent work through labels and position as well as color.

Sizes describe implemented examples, not a complete standardized token scale. Consolidating the scale is a recommended next step.

Style Guide / Components

Representative specimens below translate shared component classes into a printable guide. Screenshots in the showcase provide the actual product context.

Action hierarchy

New application | Export report | Delete | Disabled

Primary: main task. Secondary: supporting action. Danger: destructive action. Hover darkens primary to #3E6199; disabled actions use reduced opacity.

Fields and focus

Student name

Enter student name

Default: neutral border and clear label.

Student name

Focused field

Focus: primary border and soft ring.

Status and feedback

Assigned | Pending | Complete

Use explicit labels. These semantic specimens illustrate intended meaning; individual modules have their own stage palettes.

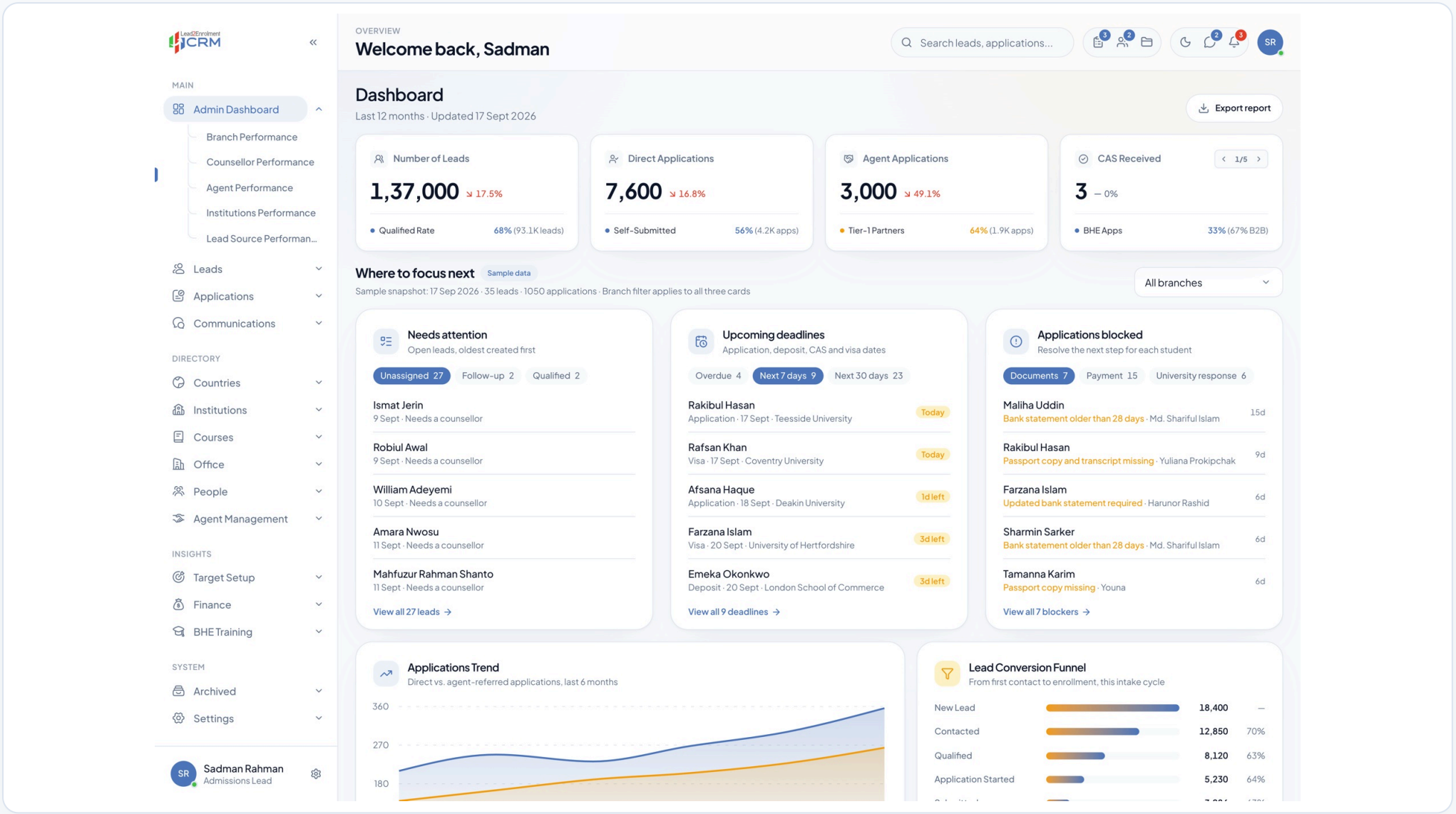
Interaction guidelines

Tables support search, filtering, selection, and contextual actions. Drawers retain list context; modals isolate focused decisions. Show success only after the intended operation has completed.

Accessibility work remains: verify contrast, complete dialog focus trapping and restoration, check icon labels, and test keyboard and narrow-screen flows.

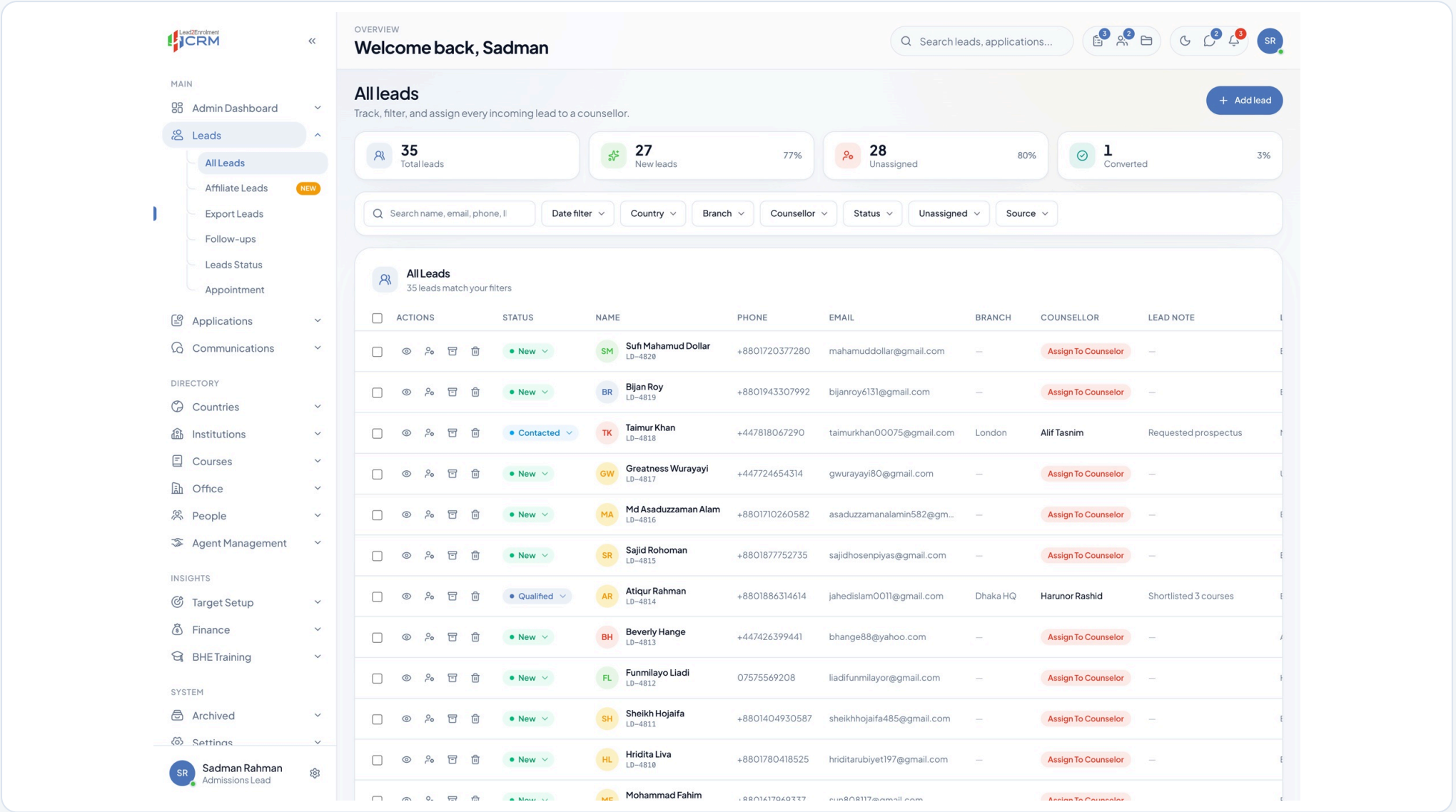
Business overview

A shared starting point combines recruitment figures with operational queues, deadlines, and blockers. Hierarchy: summary metrics → attention queues → trend analysis.



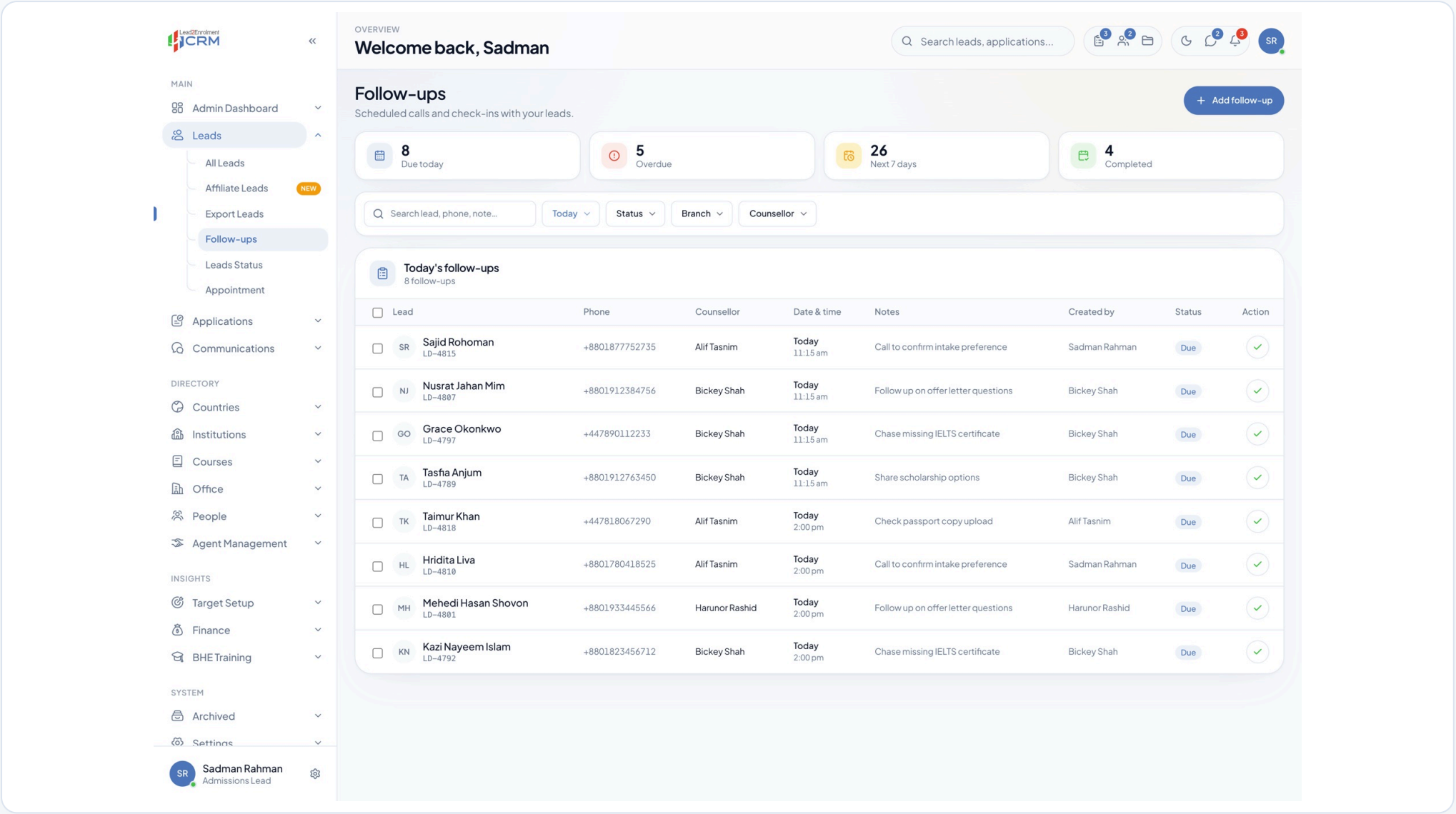
Lead management

Filters and ownership information help staff locate enquiries and coordinate assignments. Pattern: searchable table with contextual record actions.



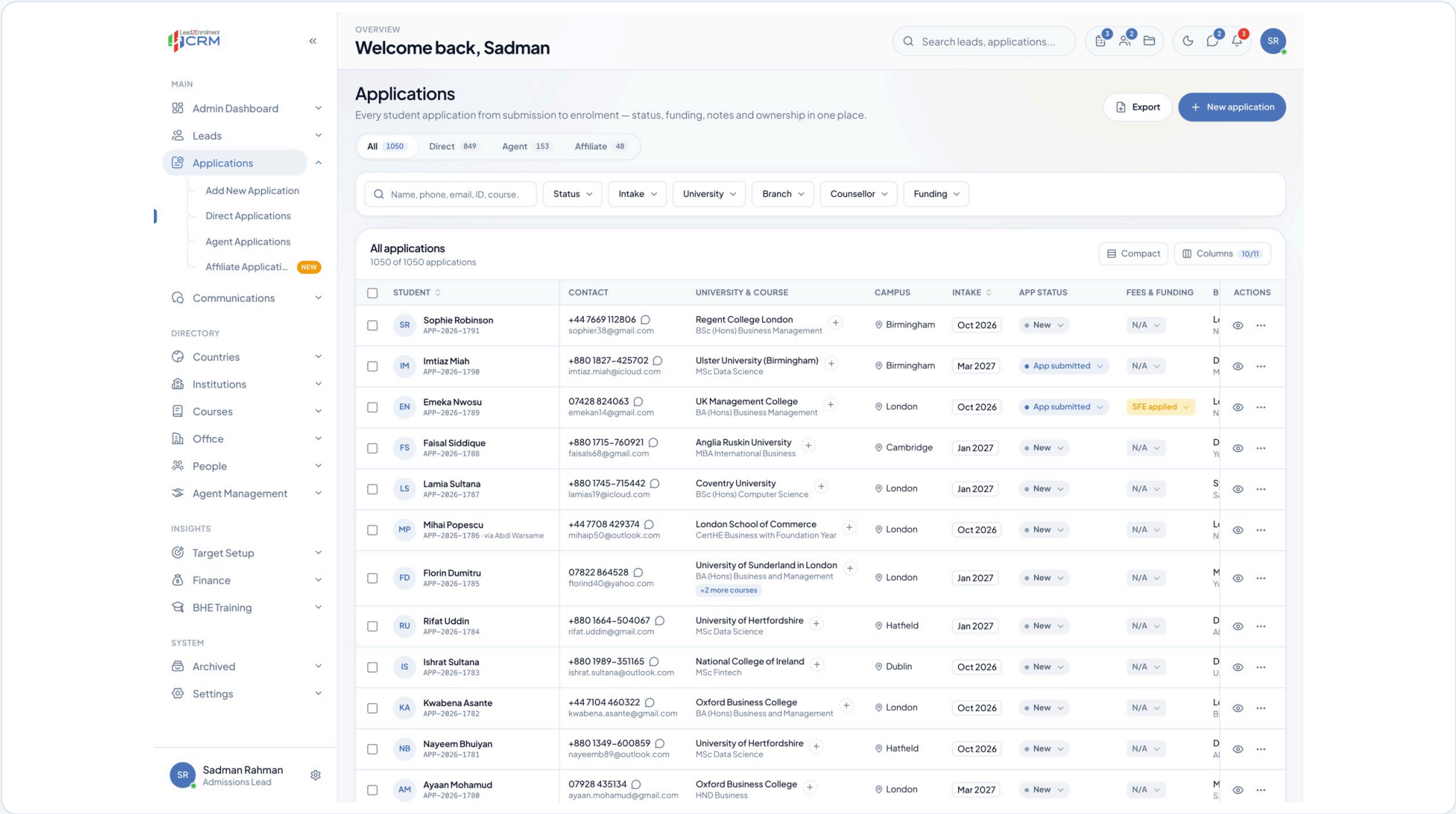
Follow-up planner

Scheduled activity gives counselling teams a view of pending and completed follow-ups. Intent: make the next contact visible alongside student context.



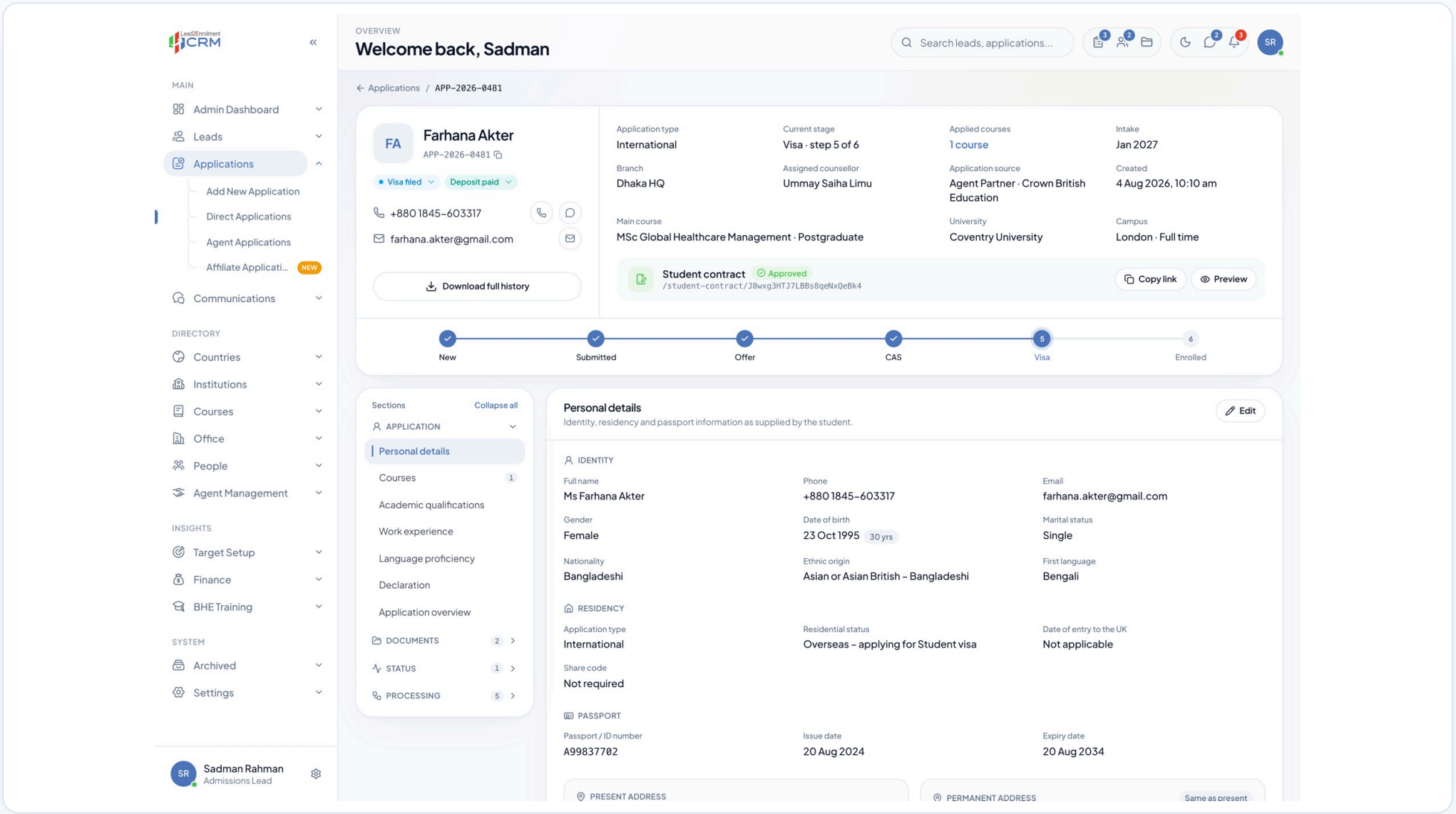
Application pipeline

Application stages, intake information, and ownership support admissions tracking. Pattern: dense records organized through filters and status labels.



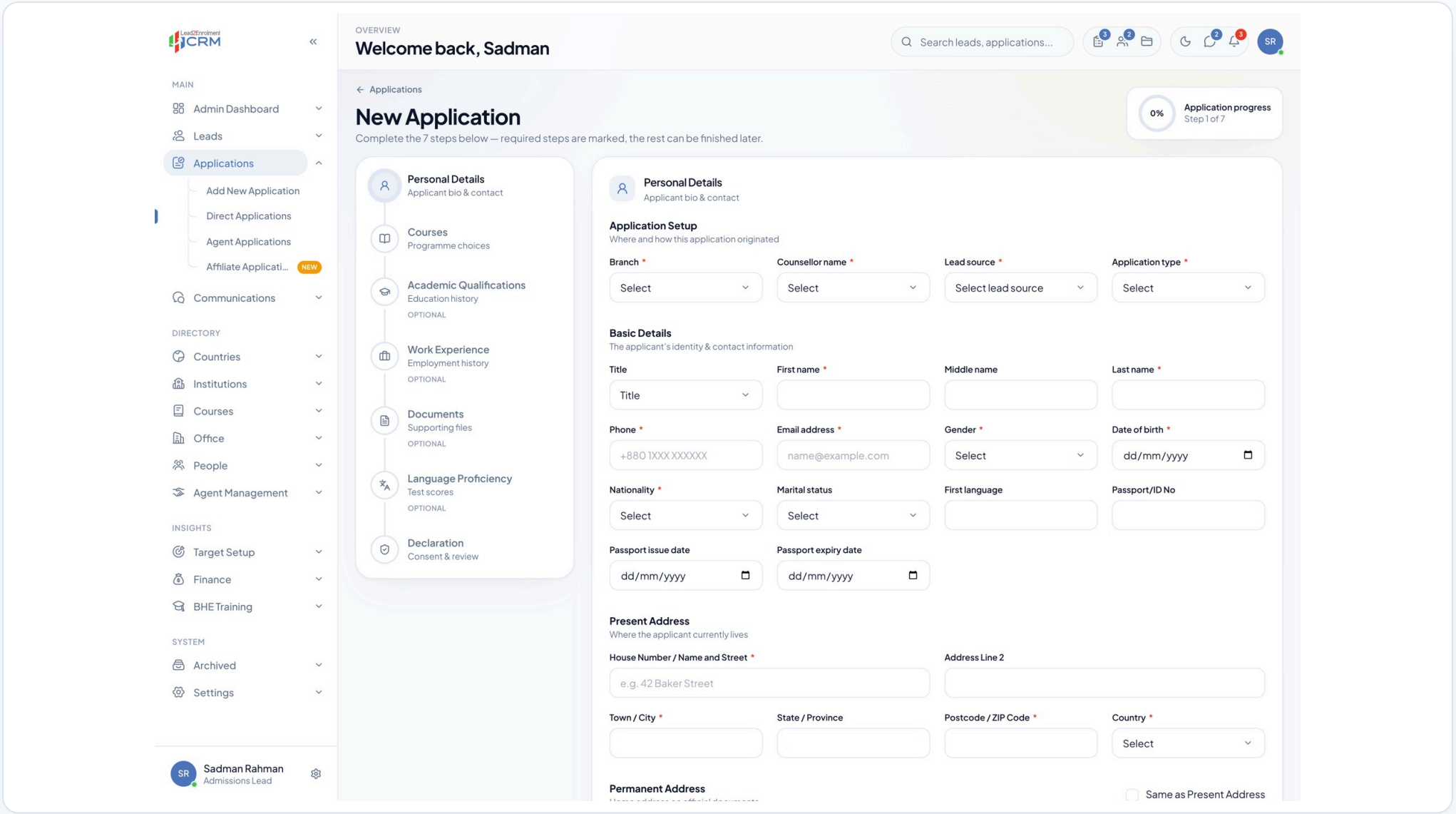
Student application detail

A dedicated record brings application information and operational activities together. Intent: reduce repeated searching across disconnected views.



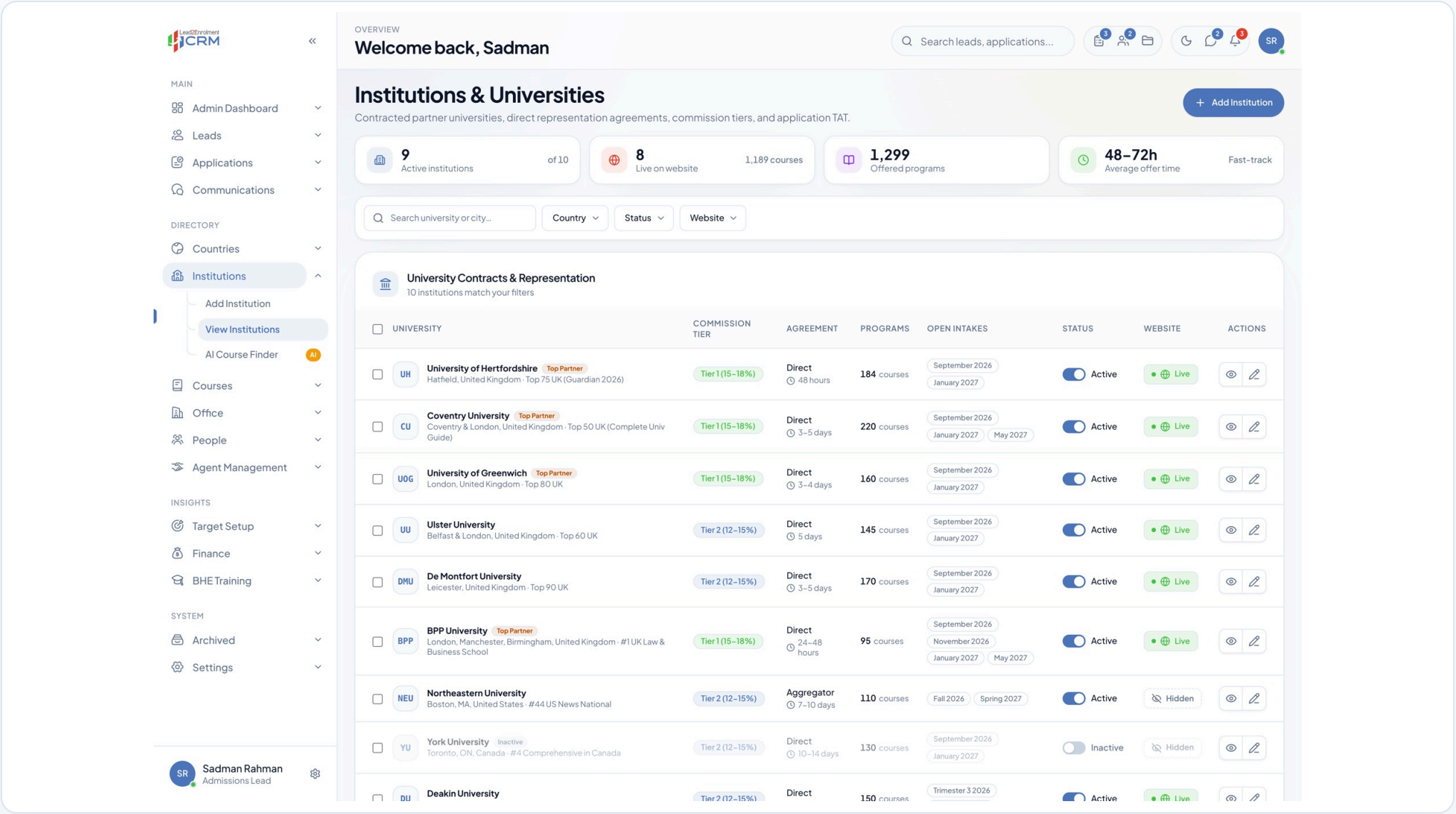
Guided application

A staged form separates student details and supporting information into manageable sections. Pattern: step navigation and progress feedback; submission persistence remains incomplete.



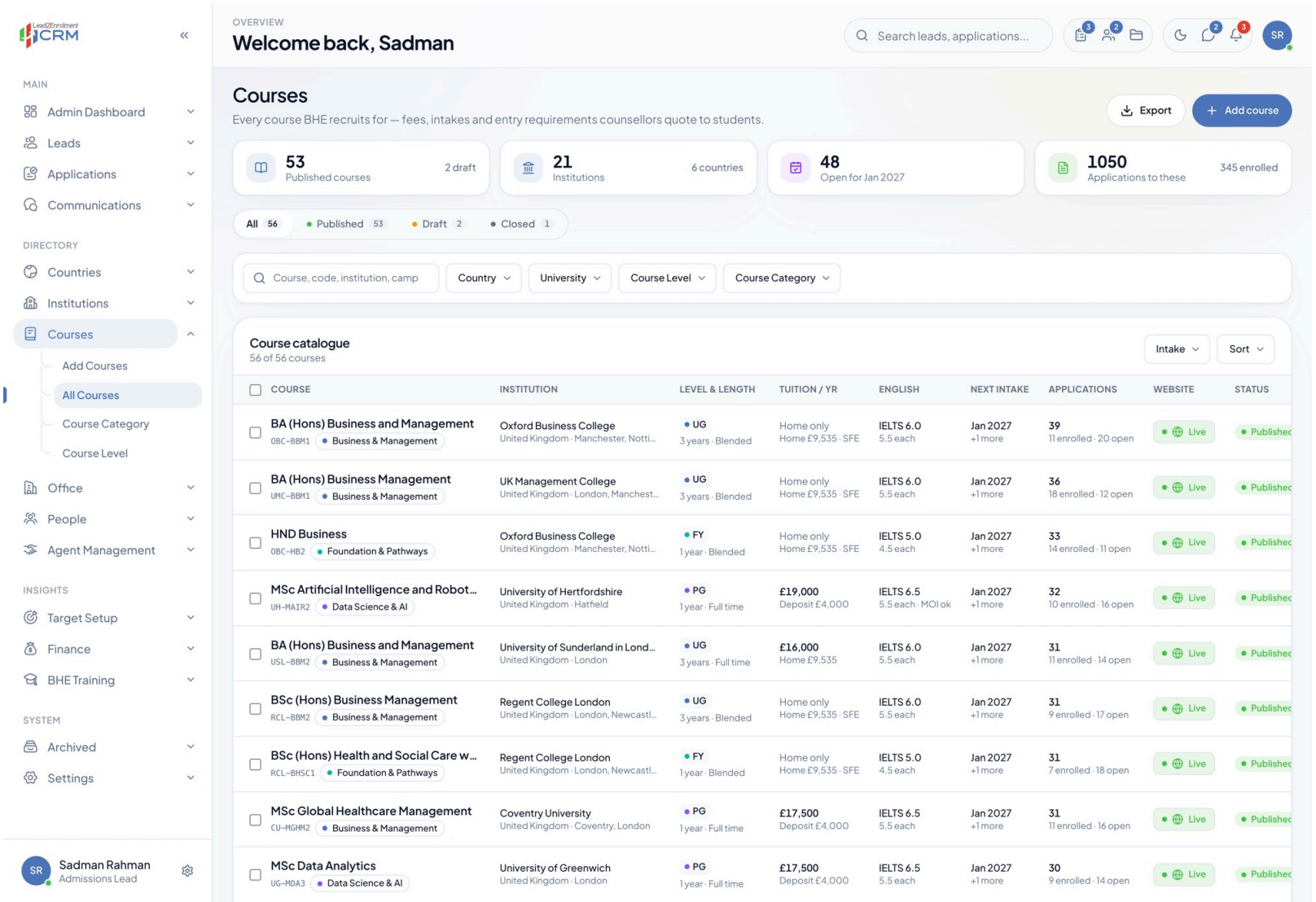
Institution directory

Institution information supports destination exploration and student counselling. Pattern: browse and filter a shared reference catalogue.



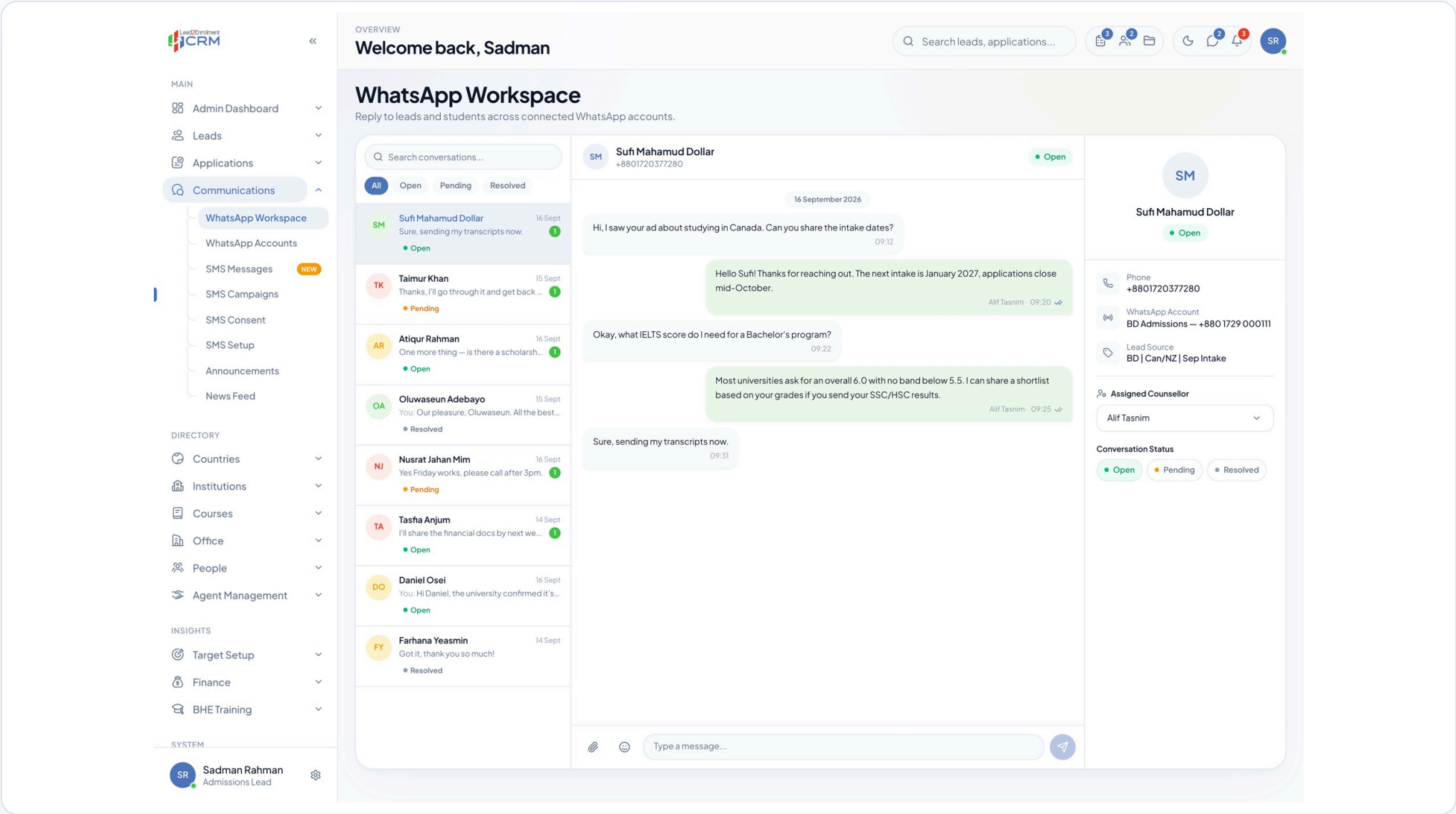
Course catalogue

Course records support comparison of academic options during counselling. Intent: provide consistent reference information across student conversations.



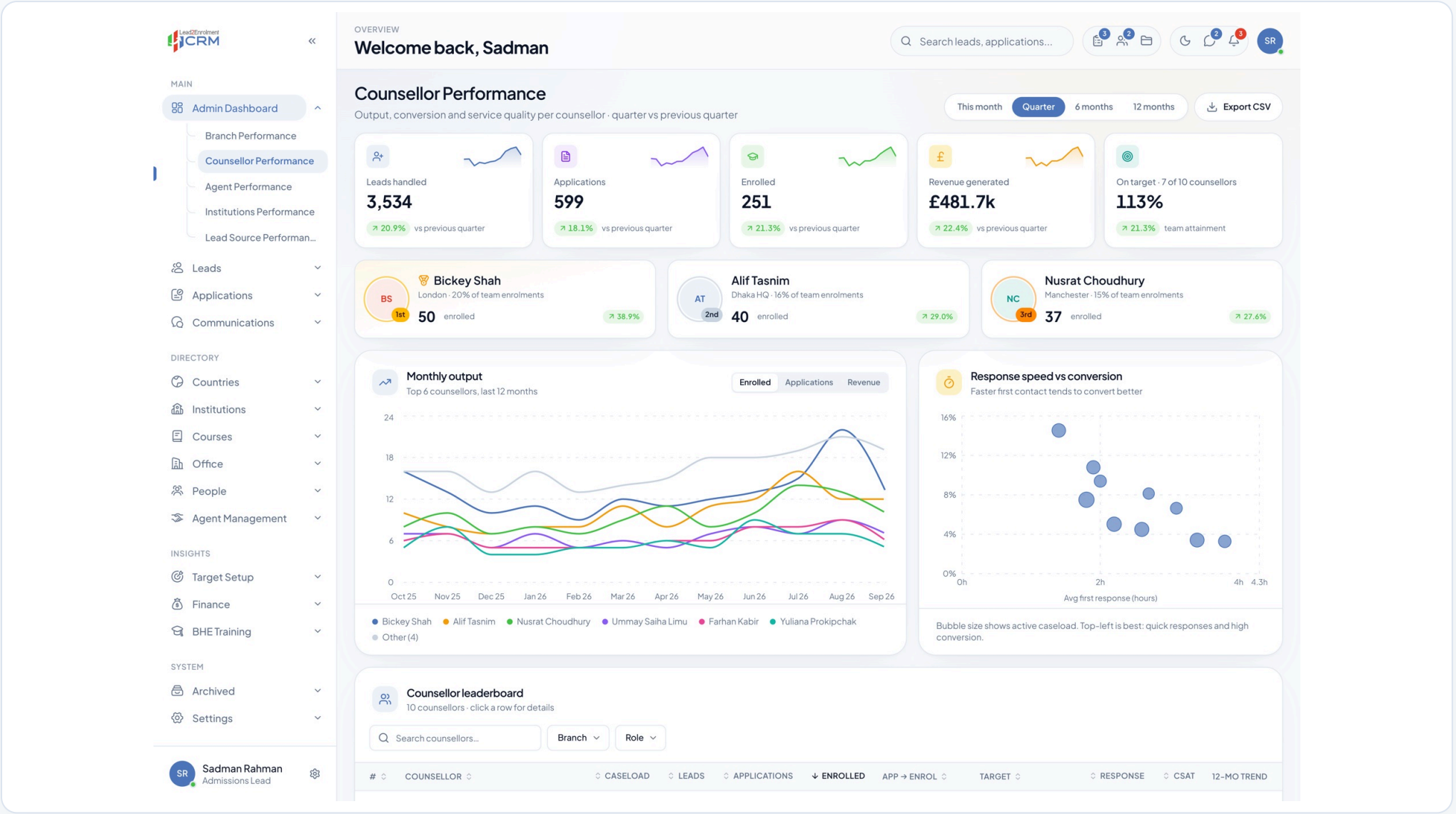
WhatsApp workspace

Conversation list, chat, and contact context share one communication workspace. Pattern: three-pane desktop layout; current send behavior is simulated.



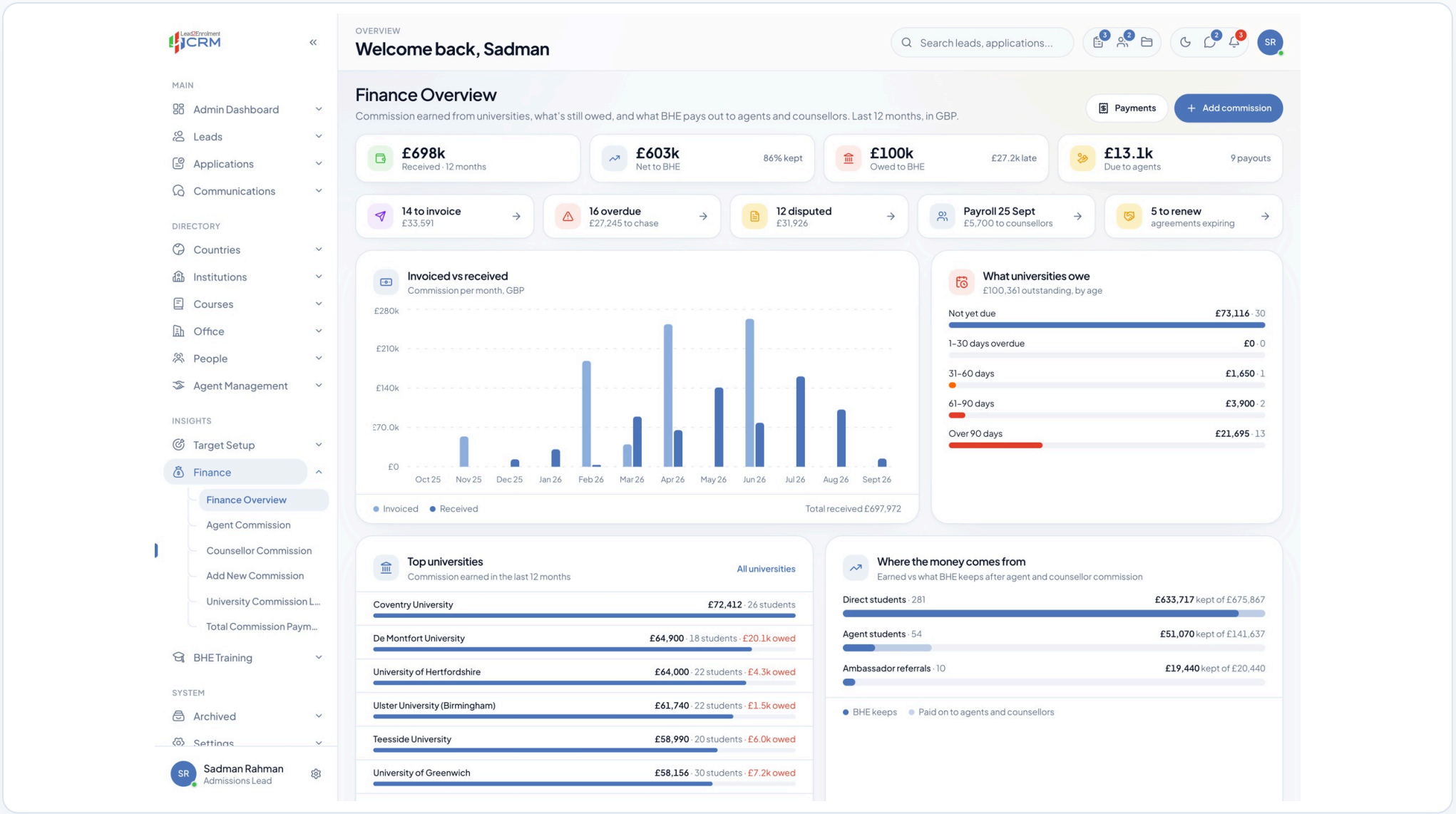
Counsellor performance

Comparative reporting helps managers examine activity and conversion indicators. Intent: provide visibility; displayed figures are prototype data, not measured impact.



Finance overview

Financial summaries organize commission-related activity and outstanding amounts. Pattern: summary indicators with supporting operational records.



Agent management

Partner records organize the agent network and referral relationships. Intent: support partner coordination alongside the admissions lifecycle.

